University of Lausanne
HEC Lausanne Spring 2023

Country Report – Questions and Answers
INTERNATIONAL MONEY AND FINANCE

Data

[D-1] I cannot find data for the nominal and the real exchange rate of my country. Are there any alternatives?

Yes, you can use nominal and real effective exchange rates (NEER and REER) instead. The following databases may be helpful:

- Bruegel: REER Database (includes NEERs)
- BIS: EER Indices, BIS Statistics Explorer

[D-2] For some points, we are required to discuss the evolution over recent years and the current level. What should we focus on?

You should decide yourself what to focus on. The decision may especially depend on the course of events in a country.
As an example: If GDP growth has stayed constant for the past 10 years, there is no need to go into too much detail. Instead, you may describe stabilization policies. However, if there was a huge recession in 2014 from which the country has not fully recovered yet, it is advisable to dig a bit deeper, as such an occurrence may strongly influence your final conclusion.

[D-3] In question 1 we are asked to plot multiple time series. Do we need to create one plot for each series?

No, you can design the report and the charts as you wish. Just keep in mind that 1. Everything from the instructions needs to be covered and 2. the charts help to underline your thoughts and conclusion. Further, remember that a chart helps to get a quick overview, when it is tidy and concise. When you put too many things into a single chart it might be overwhelming and in the worst case useless for the reader.

Sources / References

[S-1] Should I mention the sources that I used after each sentence, or just list all the sources used in a bibliography at the end of my report?

We should be able to recover easily every information/data/quotation that you use. There are different possibilities how you can reference (non-exhaustive list):

- Use in-text citation (e.g. APA style) together with an appropriate bibliography at the end
- Put a superscript/number in the text and add the full source as either a footnote or an endnote
- Put a superscript/number in the text, add a shortened version of the source as a footnote or endnote, and create an appropriate bibliography at the end

Please consider that footnotes are included in the maximum report size of 3 pages, but endnotes and a bibliography are not.